

	Division/Section	Family Support
	Chapter No./Name	4 – Economic Stability (ES)
	Part No./Name	B - Eligibility Factors (FITAP)
	Section No./Name	B-1700-FITAP Time Limited Benefits
	Document No./Name	B-1740-FITAP Time-Limit Extensions
	Effective Date	January 1, 2023

I. STATEMENT OF POLICY

Cases approaching the 24-month and 60-month time limits must be reviewed for consideration of an extension or case closure.

II. PROCEDURES

B-1741-FITAP - PR *** OFFICE RESPONSIBILITIES

The * ES office is responsible to review:

- cases approaching the 24-month and 60-month time limits for consideration of an extension at application, and ** ***
- * Ongoing FITAP cases for ineligible aliens.

The WD STEP office is responsible to review:

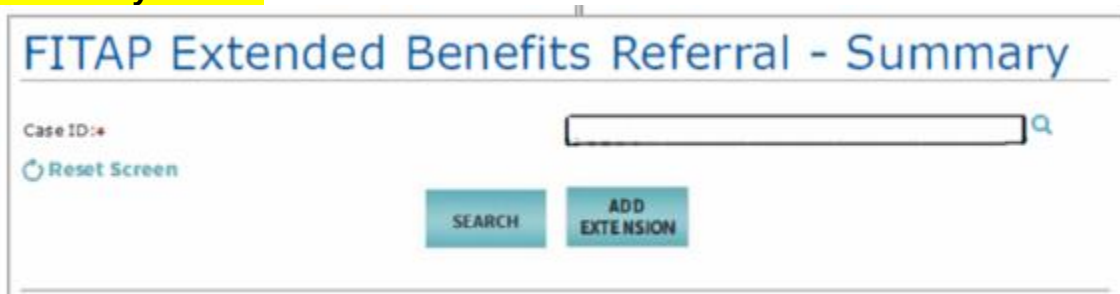
- Ongoing cases approaching the 24-month time limit,
- Ongoing cases approaching the 60-month time limit, and
- Subsequent extensions for ongoing cases, excluding ineligible alien cases.

B-1741-1-FITAP - PR 24-Month Time Limit Responsibilities

In the twenty-second month, the case should be reviewed by the ES worker and supervisor *** for consideration of an extension. The review is to include * an assessment of good cause, exceptions, exemptions, or hardships. **

* ES staff ** will thoroughly document *** * case notes ** regarding the approaching 24-month time limit with a clear rationale for recommendation of an extension if the client meets one of the extension reasons.

From **Others** on the main navigation bar select **Benefit Issuance** for the **FITAP Extended Benefits Referral** selection to populate. *** * The extension determination will be input in the **LITE FITAP Time Limit Decision – Details** screen which can be located through the **FITAP Extended Benefits Referral – Summary** screen.



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The user will input the CID of the member for whom the extension determination is needed then select the **Add Extension** button in order to reach the **FITAP Time Limit Decision – Details** screen.

FITAP Time Limit Decision - Details

PERSON INFORMATION

Person Name:

Person ID:

DECISION DETAILS

24 Month Time Clock Counter State:

0

60 Month Time Clock Counter Federal:

0

Benefit Month:

12/2022

Decision Date:

MM / DD / YYYY

Decision:

Approve

Denial Reason:

Extension Reason:

Hardship
Loss of Job/No Fault
Maintain Compliance with FSA
Pending Appeal
Unfavorable Job Factors

Start Month:

End Month:

Staff ID:

Date:

12/07/2022 11:32 AM

SUPERVISOR REVIEW

Supervisor Name:

Decision Reviewed:

☐

Date:

Reset Screen

CANCEL
SUBMIT

This screen allows the worker to create an extension request for approval. Once the worker inputs all the required information then clicks Submit, LITE will generate a **Benefit Clock Extension** task item for the supervisor to review and authorize or deny the extension request.

Upon receipt of the **Benefit Clock Extension** task, the supervisor will start the work item. The system will bring the supervisor to the **FITAP Extended Benefits Referral – Summary** screen, with the CID already populated. The supervisor will select **Search**, followed by the **Edit Pencil** icon next to the pending approval/denial. This will bring the supervisor to the **FITAP Time Limit Decision – Details** screen where they can approve or deny the decision. If approved, the extension may be granted for no more than six months.

After the extension is approved or denied, the worker must run eligibility so the system can either extend or deny (or close) the program and issue a Notice of Decision. **

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This procedure is followed in determining eligibility for extensions to the 24-month time limit that occur at one of the following times:

- The client has received twenty-two months of FITAP,
- An extension period is expiring and additional time is needed, or
- When a client has exceeded the 24-month time-limit and reapplies for assistance.

Note: Consideration of an extension is not required for cases in which the 24-month time clock is halted due to the limited earned income deduction, or when the work registration code is *** Temporary Incapacity (WRC 03)**, **Permanent Incapacity (WRC 11)**, or **Incapacitated Single Parent (Head of Household) (WRC 24)**, and a form OFS 90 is approved for the current month, or when the time clock is halted due to a break in FITAP assistance in the prior 60 calendar month time period.

Consideration of a subsequent extension must be made by the 10th day of the last month of an extension period. The determination is based on:

- Factors relating to job availability or job loss, or
- A hardship as outlined in section B-1744 FITAP. ******

B-1741-2-FITAP - PR 60-Month Time Limit Responsibilities

In the fifty-eighth month, the case should be reviewed to determine if a condition for an extension exists. Discussion ******* *** should include: ****

- The challenges the client has had in the past and is currently facing, and
- Assessment of a hardship situation.

The *** ES** worker will thoroughly document **case notes **** regarding the approaching 60-month time limit and a clear rationale for recommendation of an extension. ******* *** The extension determination will be input in the LITE FITAP Extended Benefits Referral module on the FITAP Time Limit Decision – Details screen. This screen allows the worker to create an extension request for approval. Once the worker inputs all the required information then clicks, LITE will generate a Benefit Clock Extension task item for the supervisor to review and authorize or deny the extension request. ****

*** Upon receipt of the Benefit Clock Extension task, the supervisor will start the work item. The system will bring the supervisor to the FITAP Extended Benefits Referral – Summary screen, with the CID already populated. The supervisor will select Search, followed by the Edit Pencil icon next to the pending approval/denial. This will bring the supervisor to the FITAP Time Limit Decision – Details screen where they can approve or deny the decision. If approved, the extension may be granted for no more than six months. **** A decision must be made by the 10th day of the sixtieth month of benefits, or by the 10th day of the last month of an extension period.

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This determination should be based on:

- Factors relating to job availability or job loss, or
- A hardship as outlined in section B-1744-FITAP.

* After the extension is approved or denied, the DCFS worker must run eligibility so the system can either extend or deny (or close) the program and issue a Notice of Decision.

The determination may occur at one of the following times:

- The client has received fifty-eight months of FITAP,
- An extension period is expiring and additional time is needed, or
- When a client who has exceeded the 60-month time-limit reapplies for assistance.

B-1742-FITAP - PR TIME-LIMIT EXTENSION

Time-limit extensions are determined by supervisors for cases reaching or exceeding the 24-month and 60-month time limit.

B-1742-1-FITAP - PR Reserved

B-1742-2-FITAP - PR Reserved

B-1742-3-FITAP - PR Reserved

B-1742-4-FITAP - PR Reserved

B-1742-5-FITAP - PR Post Decision Activities

If an extension is not approved for an applicant, the **ES** worker will notify the client of the decision to reject the application.

Once a decision is made by the supervisor for an existing case and the ES worker authorizes the decision, LITE will send an automated notice of decision ** ***

- If an extension was not approved, the notice will inform the client of the date the benefits will end. The *** * automated notice ** will serve as the advance notice of closure to be effective the twenty-fifth month, sixty-first month, or the first month following a previous extension period.
- If an extension was approved, the notice will inform the client of the time period of the extension and what is expected of the client during the extension period. ***

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B-1742-6-FITAP - PR Subsequent Extensions

Subsequent extensions may be scheduled in the month prior to the last month of an extension period, but no later than the 10th day of the last month of an extension period. At the end of an extension period for the 24-month time limit, subsequent extensions will be determined as outlined in B-1741-1-FITAP. At the end of an extension period for the 60-month time limit, subsequent extensions will be determined as outlined in B-1741-2-FITAP.

* There are no Benefit Management tasks associated with subsequent extensions. The Pentaho **24-60 Month Time Limit Tracking** report will be used to determine those cases due for an upcoming subsequent extension. For further instructions on how to pull this report reference [B-1710-FITAP Time Limits](#).

B-1743-FITAP - PR REAPPLICATION

At reapplication, prior to being certified for FITAP benefits:

ES staff will review the **FITAP Time Clock – Details** screen for the applicant to determine if an extension is required at intake. The Time Limit data can be found in the **LITE Benefit Issuance** module located in **Others** tab on the main navigation bar.

FITAP Time Clock - Details	
PERSON INFORMATION	
Person Name:	JANE SMITH, 26F
Person ID:	123456
24 Month Time Clock Counter State:	26
Out of State Count Month(s):	0
60 Month Time Clock Counter Federal:	59
Participation Exemption Counter:	0
Total Months of Benefits Counter:	59
\$900 Earned Income Disregard Months:	5

- Applicants who have previously reached the 24-month time limit, but not the 60-month time limit, must:
 - meet an exemption to the 24-month time limit policy, or
 - be granted an extension to the 24-month time limit by the **ES **** supervisor/worker based on ******* registration for work with Louisiana Workforce Commission *******

The applicant ******* may register online at www.laworks.net, or go to their local DCFS office and register by using a kiosk located at the office.

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The locations of the B&CSC can be found by visiting LWC's website at www.laworks.net/ServiceLocator.asp

* ES ** staff *** will verify that the work-eligible FITAP applicant has an active registration in HiRE. Work-eligible FITAP applicants must have an active work registration in HiRE.

The LWC website must be reviewed * using the Clearancy Summary before during the interview to determine if the client is registered.

When ES staff reviews the LWC website in Clearance Summary and determines that the work-eligible FITAP applicant has an active HiRE account, ** staff must complete a virtual print of the screen and save in OnBase. ES ** staff must make a case note to document that the applicant is registered for work with LWC. The LWC website must only be reviewed once if the member's work registration is active. There is no need to check the website again when processing the case, unless another member is not registered for work with LWC when the website is reviewed.

If it is determined that any work-eligible FITAP applicant is not registered for work with LWC:

- after all required verification is received, and
- before processing the application

For applicants who do not meet an exception listed above, failure to register within 10 days of the date of the [OFS 18C](#) will result in rejection of the application unless the applicant meets conditions outlined in [C-1130-FITAP](#), section C-1131-FITAP regarding requesting additional time to provide.

- Applicants who have previously reached the 24-month and the 60-month time limits must meet an exemption to the 24-month time limit eligibility and be granted an extension approved by the supervisor for the 60-month time limit.
- Applicants who have previously reached the 60-month time limit, but have not received 24 months of FITAP benefits in the previous 60-month time period, must meet an extension reason and be granted an extension approved by the supervisor for the 60-month time limit.

Note: Determine if an (re)applicant meets an extension reason prior to certifying the case.

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B-1744-FITAP - PR EXTENSION REASONS

Among other factors as discussed in [B-1720-FITAP](#), section B-1723-FITAP and [B-1730-FITAP](#), section B-1733-FITAP, a clear rationale must exist for an extension to be recommended. The following circumstances may justify a time-limit extension:

Loss of Job/No Fault (T3)

The individual loses his job as a result of factors not related to his job performance. ***

Hardship (T5)

Other hardships have occurred which affect the individual's ability to obtain employment. These hardship extensions are limited to the period of time the condition or situation is expected to last.

Examples of such hardships include:

- a) when a parent/caretaker relative is under treatment for a serious addiction and work force participation is not recommended by the treating organization, or
- b) when adequate child care or transportation is not available, or
- c) a temporary family crisis such as death of a family member, eviction, serious illness or accident has occurred, or
- d) domestic violence situations, or
- e) when a parent is required to provide full-time care to an incapacitated or disabled member of the household, or
- f) incapacity of the parent or other caretaker relative for purposes of applying the 60-month limit.

Pending Appeal (T6)

The case remains eligible pending a decision by the DCFS Bureau of Appeals.

NOTE: This reason does not require approval as a basis of extension.

 Department of Children & Family Services <i>Building a Stronger Louisiana</i>	Division/Section	Family Support
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III. FORMS AND INSTRUCTIONS

[OFS 090 Form/Instructions](#) Medical Evaluation-Physician's Report

IV. REFERENCES

[Title IV of the Social Security Act, Sec. 408](#)

[Personal Responsibility and Work Opportunity Reconciliation Act of 1996](#)

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